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ARTICLE

Can Humanity Stop What Revelation Says Is Coming From The Heavens?



BY PNW STAFF OCTOBER 23, 2026

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On April 13, 2029, an enormous asteroid named Apophis will race past Earth at a distance of just 20,000 miles from our planet's surface. That's closer than many of the satellites orbiting above us. Measuring approximately 1,100 feet across, this massive space rock will provide humanity with an extraordinary reminder of just how vulnerable our world really is.

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NASA assures us that Apophis will not strike Earth and has ruled out an impact for at least the next century. But its approaching flyby raises a much larger question: What happens when the next giant asteroid isn't going to miss?

Scientists are increasingly investing in ways to detect, track, and even destroy dangerous objects approaching Earth. Nuclear weapons, asteroid-deflecting spacecraft, and elaborate disaster simulations are all part of a growing effort to protect humanity from threats originating millions of miles away.

Yet nearly 2,000 years ago, the Apostle John described terrifying events in the Book of Revelation that sound remarkably similar to the consequences of massive celestial objects striking our planet.

A mountain burning with fire thrown into the sea. A blazing star falling from heaven and poisoning Earth's waters. Stars falling from the sky as the nations of the world tremble in fear.

Could modern planetary defense efforts be preparing humanity for the very kinds of catastrophes Scripture warns are coming?



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Humanity Is Preparing For A Threat It Cannot Ignore

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NASA and other scientific institutions are taking the asteroid threat seriously, even though no known large asteroid is currently on a collision course with Earth.

Preparations for the 2027 Planetary Defense Conference include a hypothetical impact scenario involving an object comparable to the one responsible for the devastating Tunguska explosion in Siberia in 1908.

That event flattened approximately 800 square miles of forest. Had it occurred over a densely populated modern city, the destruction could have been catastrophic.

In 2013, a much smaller meteor exploded over Chelyabinsk, Russia, injuring roughly 1,500 people, primarily from shattered windows. The object had approached from the direction of the sun, making it difficult to detect beforehand.

Now imagine an asteroid hundreds of feet across approaching a major metropolitan area.

Scientists at Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory have been conducting advanced simulations examining whether nuclear explosions could deflect or disrupt threatening asteroids. NASA has already demonstrated one form of planetary defense through its successful DART mission, which deliberately crashed a spacecraft into an asteroid moonlet and altered its orbit.

These aren't preparations for a confirmed incoming disaster. They are efforts to prevent a catastrophe that history tells us is possible.

But there is something sobering about humanity's sudden realization that threats from the heavens could overwhelm even our most advanced civilization.



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When A Mountain Of Fire Falls Into The Sea

One of Revelation's most astonishing descriptions appears in Revelation 8:8–9:

"And the second angel sounded, and as it were a great mountain burning with fire was cast into the sea: and the third part of the sea became blood."

John continues by describing the death of a third of the creatures living in the sea and the destruction of a third of the ships.

For centuries, Bible readers could scarcely imagine what such an event might look like. Today, the image of a massive asteroid plunging into the ocean provides a chilling possible comparison.

An enormous impact could unleash unimaginable energy, generating destructive waves, devastating nearby coastlines, and destroying ships and coastal infrastructure across a vast region.

Consider the consequences for our interconnected world. Major shipping routes could be disrupted, critical ports destroyed, energy supplies interrupted, and international trade thrown into chaos. Coastal cities housing millions of people could face destruction.

The biblical description goes even further, depicting devastation on a scale beyond an ordinary regional disaster.

Scripture does not specifically identify the burning mountain as an asteroid. Nevertheless, the imagery bears a striking resemblance to the kind of catastrophe scientists now recognize as physically possible.

And Revelation's next trumpet judgment is equally disturbing.

Wormwood: When The World's Water Turns Bitter

Revelation 8:10–11 describes another terrifying event:

"And the third angel sounded, and there fell a great star from heaven, burning as it were a lamp, and it fell upon the third part of the rivers, and upon the fountains of waters."

The star is given a name: Wormwood.

The passage says that a third of the waters become bitter and many people die from drinking them.

Unlike the previous judgment, which strikes the sea, this one targets freshwater—the very resource upon which human survival depends.

Could John have been describing a comet, an asteroid fragment, or some other celestial object whose impact would contaminate vast water systems?

The text doesn't explain the physical mechanism. Some interpreters understand Wormwood as a literal object falling from heaven, while others see supernatural or symbolic judgment.

But imagine the consequences if enormous regions suddenly lost access to safe drinking water.

Cities would face immediate emergencies. Hospitals, agriculture, food processing, and sanitation systems would be affected. Millions could be forced to flee in search of uncontaminated water.

Human beings can survive disruptions to electricity, transportation, and communications. Without water, survival becomes a matter of days.

The frightening aspect of Wormwood is not simply that something falls from the sky. It is that the consequences continue long after the initial event.

Stars Falling, The Sun Darkened, Nations Terrified

The Book of Revelation contains additional descriptions of disturbances in the heavens.

Revelation 6:13 describes the stars of heaven falling to Earth like figs shaken from a tree by a mighty wind. The following verse describes the heavens departing like a scroll and mountains and islands being moved.

Revelation 8:12 describes a third of the sun, moon, and stars being darkened.

Jesus Himself warned in Luke 21:25–26 of signs in the sun, moon, and stars, distress among nations, the roaring of the seas, and people becoming fearful because of what is coming upon the Earth.

These passages describe events far beyond the meteor showers we admire on clear nights.

Scientists already understand that sufficiently large asteroid impacts could throw enormous quantities of dust and debris into the atmosphere, reduce sunlight, disrupt global temperatures, and threaten agricultural production.

Imagine food shortages spreading across continents, supply chains breaking down, and governments confronting disasters that no emergency response system was designed to handle.

The parallels do not prove that every biblical description refers to an asteroid. God's judgments may involve supernatural events beyond anything modern science can explain.

But the growing scientific understanding of cosmic hazards makes the imagery of Revelation more sobering than ever.

Can Technology Stop The Judgments Of God?

Humanity has made extraordinary technological advances. We can land spacecraft on distant asteroids, collect samples from their surfaces, calculate orbital trajectories, and even alter the movement of objects in space.

Yet our defenses remain limited. A dangerous object discovered too late, approaching from an unexpected direction, or possessing an unusual composition could present challenges beyond our ability to overcome.

And the judgments described in Revelation are not portrayed as random accidents of nature. They unfold under God's sovereign authority.

That distinction changes everything.

If the burning mountain, Wormwood, and falling stars represent literal celestial objects, no amount of human ingenuity can overturn what God has determined. If they represent supernatural judgments, humanity's technological defenses would be even less relevant.

This does not mean scientists should abandon planetary defense. Protecting human life is a worthy endeavor. But there is a profound difference between preparing for natural disasters and believing that technology can ultimately shield civilization from divine judgment.

Apophis is not predicted to strike Earth in 2029, and there is no biblical basis for identifying it as Wormwood or assigning it a prophetic role.

Its approach nevertheless offers a timely reminder of a truth modern civilization often forgets: Our world is far more fragile than we imagine.

The Bible warns of a future when the heavens will shake, the seas will be struck, and the nations will discover the limits of human power.

Scientists may one day save a city—or even civilization—from an incoming asteroid. But when the judgments of Revelation unfold, the ultimate question will not be whether humanity has developed sufficiently powerful weapons to defend itself.

It will be whether humanity is prepared to stand before the God who created the heavens in the first place.

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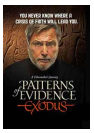
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